

POS — User Manual

For the people who run the store: cashiers, supervisors, managers, and the operator who installs the system. Covers the register and the back office.

Revision History

Version	Date	Changes
1.0	2026-07-22	First edition: register, back office, troubleshooting, FAQ, glossary.

1. Introduction

This manual covers everything you need to run the store day to day, and everything a manager needs to set it up. It's written for four kinds of reader, and you don't need to read the parts that aren't yours:

- **Cashiers** ring up sales and take payments.
- **Supervisors** do everything a cashier does, plus the actions that let money or stock leave the business without a customer noticing — voids, discounts, refunds, and approving a drawer that doesn't balance.
- **Managers** (admins) run the back office — the menu, staff, locations, and reports.
- **Operators** install and keep the system running.

The chapters are ordered the way the system is actually used: the overview comes first (Chapters 2–3), then the register — the till a cashier or supervisor stands at (Chapters 4–7, 14), then the back office a manager signs into from a laptop (Chapters 8–13). Troubleshooting, an FAQ, and a glossary sit at the back for when something goes wrong or a term is unfamiliar.

A few conventions hold throughout:

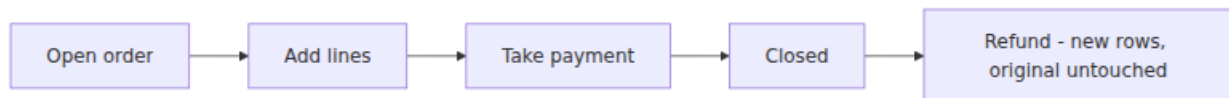
- Anything you tap or click — a button, a tab, a checkbox — appears in **bold**, exactly as it reads on screen: **Activate**, **Sign in**, **New user**.
- Money amounts are shown in pesos, because every screenshot in this manual comes from the same demo store in Manila — the figures and the prose always agree on what's on screen.
- **"Till"** means the same thing as **"register"** throughout this manual — a physical terminal, not a person. A store has several tills; each one is set up once and then used every shift after that.

2. System overview

One order, two ways of selling

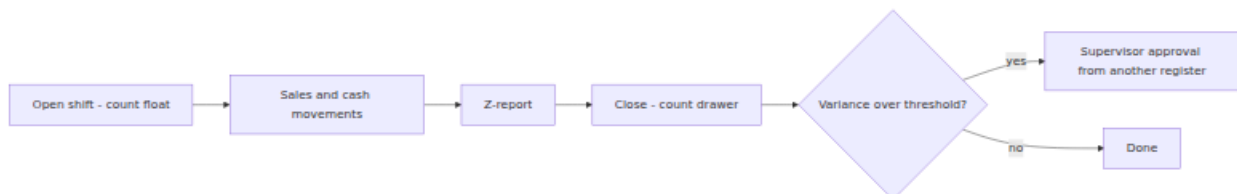
Underneath, every sale is the same thing: **open an order, add lines to it, take money, close it**. The system doesn't run two separate programs for retail and food service — it runs one order model and lets the till compress or expand it:

- **Retail** moves through that lifecycle in well under a minute, so the till collapses it into a single cart screen: scan, tap **Pay**, done.
- **Food service** lingers in the open phase for an hour or more, so that phase gets its own screen — a table, a running tab, courses fired to the kitchen — before the till ever asks for money.



A closed order is never edited. A refund doesn't erase or change the original sale — it adds new rows on top of it, so the receipt from the day of the sale still reprints exactly as it did that day, and the refund has its own paper trail.

Cash accountability follows the same shape, one level up: a till's shift opens with a counted float, runs sales and cash movements, and closes with another count.



If the counted drawer doesn't match what the system expects within a small threshold, closing records a **variance** that a supervisor has to approve — from a different till at the same location, never the one that just closed. Chapter 7 covers why.

The three surfaces

Surface	Who uses it	How it signs in
Register	Cashiers and supervisors, at a physical till	An activation code (once, per terminal — exchanged for a device token) plus a staff PIN (every shift)
Back office	Managers	An email and password — no till involved
API	The two apps above, and nothing else you should be talking to directly	Whatever the calling app is signed in as

The register and the back office are separate applications, on separate screens — a cashier's till never loads back-office code, and a manager's laptop never needs a device token. Both talk to the same server underneath, so a sale rung up at the till shows up in the back office's reports immediately, with nothing to sync or refresh by hand.

Roles

Three roles cover everything, and they're deliberately coarse:

- **Cashier** — rings up sales, opens and closes their own shift, takes payments.
- **Supervisor** — everything a cashier can do, plus voids, discounts, refunds, and approving a variance.
- **Admin** — full back-office access: catalog, staff, locations, reports, the audit trail.

Cashier and supervisor are assigned **per location** — the same person can be a cashier at one store and a supervisor at another, and the two never mix. Admin is different: it's a property of the person, not a role tied to a location, so an admin is an admin everywhere. There's no in-between tier yet — you're an admin with full back-office access, or you have none of it.

Locations and the demo store

Every screenshot in this manual comes from the same seeded demo business — one company, three locations, all in the Asia/Manila timezone with prices that already include tax:

Code	Name
CAF	Manila Cafe
GRC	Manila Grocery
RST	Manila Restaurant

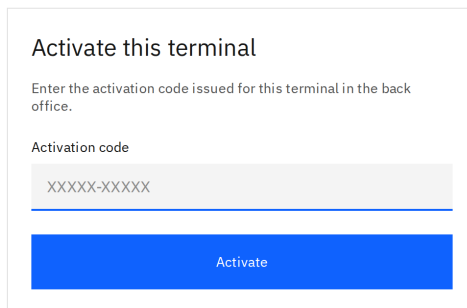
Manila Grocery runs retail (scan and go), Manila Restaurant and Manila Cafe run food service (tabs and tables). A location owns its own stock, its own registers, and its own staff assignments — nothing about a role or a stock count crosses from one location to another.

3. Getting started

Activate a register (once per terminal)

The first time a till is turned on, it shows an **Activate this terminal** screen and won't go any further until it's given an activation code.

POS Activate Terminal



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The screen reads "**Enter the activation code issued for this terminal in the back office.**" — a manager issues that code, not the person standing at the till. See [Issue an activation code](#) in Chapter 11 for how; it also covers a brand-new till's very first code, since there's no separate "first code" flow.

1. Get an activation code for this specific till from a manager.
2. Type it into **Activation code** (it's shaped like XXXXX-XXXXX).
3. Tap **Activate**.

The code is **single-use** and **expires after 7 days** — it's a one-time credential the till exchanges for its own long-lived device token, not something typed in more than once. From that point on, the device token, never the code, is what proves this terminal's identity to the server.

Reissuing a code — for a lost till, or just as routine hygiene — kills the old device token and every staff session bound to it, in the same instant the new code is created. The old till doesn't get a grace period: it drops straight to a **Terminal**

disabled lockout screen the next time it talks to the server. Chapter 11 shows that screen (Figure 11.5) and walks through issuing a fresh code from the back office.

Clock in with a PIN

Once a till is enrolled, every shift starts the same way: an **Enter PIN** screen, shown whenever nobody's currently signed in.

A screenshot of a mobile app screen titled "Enter PIN". It features a light gray input field with four dots indicating a PIN. Below the field is a blue button labeled "Clock in".

1. Type your 4–6 digit PIN.
2. Tap **Clock in**.

Five wrong PINs in a row locks that till out for 60 seconds. That's deliberate: PINs are short on purpose, and the lockout is what makes a short PIN safe to use at all.

Sign in to the back office

The back office has its own **Sign in** screen — an email and a password, nothing about a till or a device token involved.

Sign in

Email

Password

Sign in

1. Enter your **Email** and **Password**.
2. Tap **Sign in**.

Only admins can sign in here in this version — a wrong email, a wrong password, a deactivated account, and an account that isn't an admin all answer with the same message on purpose, so nobody can use the login screen to probe which email addresses exist in the system.

Common issues

Symptom	Cause	Fix
Activation code rejected	Expired (7 days) or already used	Get a fresh code from the back office (Chapter 11)
Till stuck on "Enter PIN", nothing happens	Five wrong PINs in a row	Wait 60 seconds, then try again
Back-office sign-in always says "incorrect"	Wrong email/password, account deactivated, or the account isn't an admin	All four cases look identical on purpose; ask another admin to check the account in Chapter 10

4. The register

Written in the next revision pass.

5. Retail selling

Written in the next revision pass.

6. Food service

Written in the next revision pass.

7. Shifts and cash

Written in the next revision pass.

8. The back office

Layout

Everything in the back office sits behind one sign-in. Once you're in, a rail down the left holds six sections under two headings — **Operations: Today, Catalog, Users, Locations & Registers; Insights: Reports, Audit**. A **location switcher** sits above the rail, and your name plus a **Sign out** button sit at the bottom.

Today, Reports, and the **Stock** report all read whichever location the switcher is set to — there's no separate location picker on each of those screens. Change the location once, at the top, and every screen that cares about it follows along.

Today

Today is what you land on right after signing in — a glance at whichever location the switcher is set to, right now, with nothing to configure.

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Today

What's happening at this location right now.

Net sales today

₱0.00

Orders closed

0

Refunds today

₱0.00

Low stock

0

Needs attention

All clear

Nothing needs your attention right now.

Recent activity

When	Action	User
2026-07-22 06:59:55+00	admin.login	Priya Admin
2026-07-22 06:59:53+00	shift.close	Bob Supervisor
2026-07-22 06:59:52+00	payment.take	Bob Supervisor

The screen shows:

- A row of four figures — **Net sales today, Orders closed, Refunds today**, and **Low stock** — the same numbers the Sales and Stock reports show, just for today and this location.

- **Needs attention** — a table of every low-stock variant and every inactive register at this location. Nothing to flag shows "**All clear**" instead of an empty table, exactly as it does in the figure above.
- **Recent activity** — the first page of the audit log (When, Action, User), trimmed to a glance.

Every number on **Today** already exists somewhere else in the back office — gathered onto one screen rather than computed specially. If a figure here ever looks off, the matching report (Reports, Stock, Locations & Registers, Audit) is where to double-check it.

9. Catalog

Catalog is where the menu lives — categories, products and their variants, modifier groups, discounts, and tax rates, each on its own tab.

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Products Variants Categories Modifier groups Discounts Tax rates

Products

New

Name	Category	Kind	Actions
555 Spanish Style Sardines	Canned Goods	goods	Edit
555 tuna afritada 155g	Canned Goods	goods	Edit
Ajinomoto crispy fry (r) original 62g	Pantry Staples	goods	Edit
Americano	Coffee	goods	Edit
Amos Peelerz Gummy Peach	Snacks	goods	Edit
Apple green tea	Beverages	goods	Edit
Argentina Canned Meat Loaf	Canned Goods	goods	Edit
Argentina Corned Beef	Canned Goods	goods	Edit
Arroz Caldo	Noodles & Rice	goods	Edit

Products and variants

A **product** is the thing on the menu — a name, a description, a category. A **variant** is what's actually sold under that product: its own SKU, barcode, price, cost, and tax rate. Every product needs at least one variant before it can be rung up at all.

1. In **Catalog**, tap **Products**, then **New**.
2. Fill in **Name**, **Description**, **Category**, and **Kind (Goods or Service)**.
3. Tap **Save**.
4. Tap **Variants**, then **New**.
5. Pick the product, then fill in **Name**, **SKU**, **Barcode** (optional), **Price**, **Cost** (optional), **Tax rate**, and **Track inventory**.
6. Tap **Save**.

Prices and costs are typed as pesos (e.g. 120.00) but travel to the server as cents — a blank or unparseable price is refused before it's ever sent.

Modifier groups

To attach a modifier group (a coffee's milk, a dish's extras) to a product, open the product again — a **Modifier groups** panel at the bottom lists every group as a checkbox.

The screenshot shows the 'Edit product' interface for 'Chicken Adobo'. The left sidebar contains a navigation menu with 'Catalog' selected. The main content area has fields for Name, Description, Category, Kind, and an Active checkbox. Below these is the 'Modifier groups' section, which includes checkboxes for 'Add-ons #2', 'Cup Size', 'Extras', 'Milk', 'Rice #1', 'Serving Size', and 'Spice Level'. The 'Rice #1' checkbox is checked and highlighted with a blue border. A 'Save modifier groups' button is located at the bottom of this section. The top right of the main content area has a 'Back' button. The bottom left of the sidebar shows the user 'Priya Admin' and a 'Sign out' button.

The figure above shows **Chicken Adobo** with **Rice** ticked first (shown as **#1**) and **Add-ons** ticked second (**#2**) — the order you tick groups in is recorded against each checkbox. Tapping **Save modifier groups** is a separate action from the product's own **Save** button above it, and it's a full replace of the product's attached groups, not an add-one/remove-one — so an untouched box you meant to keep still has to be ticked before you save.

Categories and modifier groups themselves have no archive toggle — only the modifiers inside a group, and the variants inside a product, do. A group with **Min select** at 1 or more shows up as required at the till: the cashier can't confirm an item until every required group has a pick.

Discounts and tax rates

Discounts (its own tab): **Name**, **Kind** (**Percent** or **Fixed amount**), the matching value, **Scope** (**Order** or **Line**), **Requires supervisor**, **Active**.

Tax rates (its own tab): **Name**, **Rate (%)** — typed as a percent (e.g. 12.00), stored and computed on the server as an exact fraction so the math never drifts.

Archive, never delete

There is no delete button anywhere in the back office. Unchecking **Active** and tapping **Save** on a product, variant, discount, or tax rate **archives** it instead — it leaves the register's menu, but every past order line, receipt, and report that points at it keeps working, forever. A confirm dialog asks first — "**Archive Name? It leaves the register catalog but stays in history.**" — and an archived row shows greyed with an **ARCHIVED** badge and an **Unarchive** button.

Common issues

Symptom	Cause	Fix
I archived an item and it's still on the till	The register's menu caches the catalog for 5 minutes	Normal — wait it out, or scan the barcode instead (a scan always hits the server)
A receipt from last month shows the old price after I repriced the variant	Every order line snapshots its price when it's added — receipts never look up the live catalog	Expected behavior, not a bug — see Chapter 12 for how this is proven
A new product has no Modifier groups panel	The panel only appears once the product has been saved once (so it has an id)	Save the product first, then open it again

10. Users and roles

Hire a cashier or a supervisor

1. In **Users**, tap **New user**.
2. Fill in **Name**, and either an **Email**, a **PIN**, or both — one of the two is required for a new hire.
3. Leave **Admin** unchecked for regular staff.
4. Under **Roles**, pick a location in **Add location**, pick **Cashier** or **Supervisor** in **Add role**, then tap **Add**. Repeat for every location this person works at.
5. Tap **Save**.

Users					New user
Name	Email	Admin	Roles	Actions	
Alice Cashier	—	No	Manila Grocery (cashier), Manila Restaurant (cashier), Manila Cafe (cashier)	Edit	
Bob Supervisor	—	No	Manila Grocery (supervisor), Manila Restaurant (supervisor), Manila Cafe (supervisor)	Edit	
Maria Both	—	No	Manila Grocery (cashier), Manila Restaurant (supervisor)	Edit	
Priya Admin	admin@pos.test	Yes	—	Edit	

The figure above shows the shape this takes in practice: **Alice Cashier** holds the cashier role at all three locations, **Bob Supervisor** holds supervisor at all three, **Maria Both** is a cashier at Manila Grocery and a supervisor at Manila Restaurant, and **Priya Admin** — the only row with an email and no location roles at all — is a full admin instead.

Saving the **Roles** table writes the complete set of that person's role assignments in one action, the same way saving modifier groups does in Chapter 9 — tap **Remove** next to a row to drop a single location assignment before you save, rather than expecting to edit it after the fact.

Give someone back-office access

Check **Admin** on their user record and save. There's no in-between tier yet: admin is full access to **Catalog, Users, Locations & Registers, Reports**, and **Audit**, or nothing.

Deactivate a leaver

Open their user record, uncheck **Active**, and tap **Save** — you'll be asked to confirm: "**Deactivate Name? They keep their history but can no longer sign in.**" Their name still shows correctly on every past order, audit entry, and report they touched; deactivating only blocks a future sign-in. A **Reactivate** button brings them back later if needed.

The self-lockout guard

You cannot uncheck your **own Admin** box, and you cannot uncheck your **own Active** box. Either one is refused outright, because there's exactly one admin tier and no fallback above it — if you could lock yourself out, there might be no one left who could undo it. Have a second admin make the change if one genuinely needs to leave.

11. Locations and registers

Location settings

Locations & Registers → **Locations** tab lists every store: **Code**, **Name**, **Timezone**, **Prices include tax**, with an **Edit** action.

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New location

Code	Name	Timezone	Prices include tax	Actions
CAF	Manila Cafe	Asia/Manila	Yes	Edit
GRC	Manila Grocery	Asia/Manila	Yes	Edit
RST	Manila Restaurant	Asia/Manila	Yes	Edit

All three of the demo locations shown above — **Manila Cafe**, **Manila Grocery**, **Manila Restaurant** — run on the **Asia/Manila** timezone with **Prices include tax** set to **Yes**. Editing a location lets you change its **Name**, **Code**, **Timezone** (checked against the IANA list), **Prices include tax**, **Receipt header**, and **Receipt footer**. Flipping **Prices include tax** only applies to future orders — an order already open keeps the pricing basis it started with.

A location can be deactivated the same way as everything else in the back office — uncheck **Active**, confirm, and staff can no longer sign in there, though its history stays intact.

Register mode

Locations & Registers → **Registers** tab lists every till across every location, with its **Mode**.

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New register

Name	Location	Mode	Actions
Till 1	Manila Cafe	food	Edit
Till 1	Manila Grocery	retail	Edit
Till 1	Manila Restaurant	food	Edit
Till 2	Manila Grocery	retail	Edit
Till 2	Manila Cafe	food	Edit
Till 2	Manila Restaurant	food	Edit

Till 1 at Manila Grocery runs **retail** — the scan-and-cart screen; every other till in the figure above runs **food** — the floor-and-menu-grid screen. Flipping a register's mode is a two-tap edit:

1. **Locations & Registers** → **Registers** → **Edit** on the till.
2. Under **Mode**, tap **Retail** or **Food**.
3. Tap **Save**.

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Edit register

Back

Location: Manila Restaurant

Name

Till 2

Mode

Retail

Food

Active

☒

Save

Activation

Enrolled

Issuing a new activation code locks this terminal out immediately; it comes back when someone enters the new code on the till.

Issue activation code

There's no in-between — it's one mode or the other for the whole register, and it decides which screen that till's app shows the next time someone signs in there. A register can be deactivated the same way as a location; **Reactivate** brings it back.

Issue an activation code

A till proves itself with a device token, but a manager never handles that token directly — the back office only ever deals in **activation codes**, which the till itself exchanges for its device token. Every register's editor shows an **Activation** status pill: **Enrolled**, **Code pending — expires date**, **Code expired**, or **Not enrolled** — Figure 11.3 above shows **Enrolled**.

This is also how a brand-new register goes online for the first time — there is no separate "first code" screen. **New register** → fill in **Location**, **Name**, **Mode** → **Save**, then reopen that same till with **Edit** and follow the steps below, exactly as they apply to replacing a lost or stolen terminal's code.

1. **Locations & Registers** → **Registers** → **Edit** on the till.
2. Under **Activation**, tap **Issue activation code**.
3. Confirm: **"Issue a new activation code for Name? The current till goes dark immediately."**
4. The new code appears once, in a copy-me plate.
5. Type the code into the terminal's own **Activate this terminal** screen (Chapter 3).

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Edit register

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Location: Manila Restaurant

Name

Till 2

Mode

RetailFood

Active

Save

Activation

Code pending — expires 2026-07-29

Issuing a new activation code locks this terminal out immediately; it comes back when someone enters the new code on the till.

Issue activation code

Activation code — single use, valid for 7 days. Copy it now, it will not be shown again:
56EYX-SKV8Y

The figure above shows the plate exactly as it appears: **"Activation code — single use, valid for 7 days. Copy it now, it will not be shown again:"** followed by the code itself, and the status pill already reading **"Code pending — expires 2026-07-29"**. Copy it now — closing this screen and it's gone for good; it's never written anywhere the back office can show again.

Issuing a code revokes the register's current device token and every staff session bound to it, in the same transaction that stores the new code — there's no window where a lost terminal and its replacement are both live. The old till drops back to a lockout screen the instant it next tries to talk to the server:

Terminal disabled

Your activation code has been disabled. Please contact an admin and request a new activation code.

Activation code

XXXXX-XXXXX

Activate



The message reads exactly what it says: **"Your activation code has been disabled. Please contact an admin and request a new activation code."**, with the activation-code entry form right below it — so anyone still holding the old terminal is locked out immediately, not eventually, and can get back in the moment the new code is typed in. A code that expires unused (7 days) shows **Code expired** instead — issue a fresh one the same way.

12. Reports

Sales

Reports → **Sales** tab: pick a **From/To** date range, then a group-by tab — **Day**, **Category**, or **User**. The location comes from the sidebar's location switcher.

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Export CSV

From 07/16/2026 To 07/22/2026

Day Category User

Basis: ledger (captured payments & refunds)

Bucket	Orders closed	Gross	Refunds	Net
2026-07-22	1	₱405.00	₱0.00	₱405.00
Total	1	₱405.00	₱0.00	₱405.00

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Day and **User** are **ledger-basis** — summed from actual payments and refunds that moved money, with columns **Orders closed**, **Gross**, **Refunds**, **Net**. The figure above shows exactly one order closed on 2026-07-22 at Manila Grocery: **₱405.00** gross, **₱0.00** refunded, **₱405.00** net.

Category is **line-basis** instead — summed from order lines, joined to current category names, with columns **Qty sold** and **Line total**.

These two bases are **not required to reconcile**, and that's by design, not a bug to chase down. A payment covers a whole order at once; a category breakdown has to attribute individual lines. They're answering different questions — "how much cash and card came in" versus "what sold" — so don't expect the Day total and the sum of the Category totals to match to the cent.

Tap **Export CSV** on the **Sales** tab to download the report exactly as displayed, with money figures as plain decimal strings rather than currency-formatted text.

Stock

Reports → Stock tab: tap **Low only** to filter down to items running short. The table shows **SKU**, **Name**, **Qty** — a row under threshold is highlighted and marked — **LOW**.

POS Back Office Manila Grocery · GRC ▾ Operations Today Catalog Users Locations & Registers Insights Reports Audit Priya Admin N Sign out	Sales Stock		
	Stock		
	Low only		
	SKU	Name	Qty
	GRC-NESCAFE-100	Default	19,000
	GRC-LUCKYME-60	Default	19,000
	GRC-TUNA-420	Default	19,000
	GRC-BANGUS-KG	Default	20,000
	GRC-RICE-KG	Default	20,000
	GRC-LIEMPO-KG	Default	20,000
LOW	GRC-CHICKEN-KG	Default	20,000
	GRC-TILAPIA-KG	Default	20,000
	GRC-COKE-300	Mismo 300ml	20,000
	GRC-COKE-1L	1L	20,000
	GRC-COKE-1_5L	1.5L	20,000

13. Audit log

Audit shows every write anywhere in the system — the register and the back office alike — one row per change: **When, Action, Entity, User, Register, Payload**.

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Entity type

Entity id

User id

Action

From

To

Filter

When	Action	Entity	User	Register	Payload
2026-07-22 07:00:03+00	admin.register.code_issue	Register 019f889e-96e7-71cb-8ddd-71d632f9462f	Priya Admin	—	—
2026-07-22 06:59:55+00	admin.login	User 019f889e-a02b-735d-9bcb-2e100f662677	Priya Admin	—	—
2026-07-22 06:59:53+00	shift.close	Shift 019f889f-9034-736a-8496-a1cfff1d6570	Bob Supervisor	Till 1	Payload
2026-07-22 06:59:52+00	payment.take	Payment 019f889f-a92f-7033-82d8-fe2372c09804	Bob Supervisor	Till 1	Payload
2026-07-22 06:59:50+00	order.line.add	OrderLine 019f889f-9ff5-73a0-a93c-d4fe47af0d59	Bob Supervisor	Till 1	Payload
2026-07-22 06:59:50+00	order.line.add	OrderLine 019f889f-9e63-725c-a8f6-f3f908935680	Bob Supervisor	Till 1	Payload
2026-07-22 06:59:48+00	order.open	Order 019f889f-9925-711b-86a7-ad8e113972dd	Bob Supervisor	Till 1	—

The figure above shows what a shift's worth of activity looks like end to end: a manager issuing an activation code (`admin.register.code_issue`) and signing in (`admin.login`), then a supervisor's till closing a shift (`shift.close`), taking a payment (`payment.take`), adding order lines (`order.line.add`), and opening the order in the first place (`order.open`) — each one tagged with the till it came from where one was involved.

1. Narrow down with **Entity type** (a dropdown of every recorded kind — Order, Payment, Refund, User, Product, and so on), **Entity id**, **User id**, **Action**, and a **From/To** date range.
2. Tap **Filter** to apply them.
3. Tap **Load more** to bring in the next page (50 rows at a time) without losing the rows already on screen.

Each row's **Payload** column, where there is one, is collapsed behind a disclosure — tap it to see the raw JSON of what changed. A reprice, for instance, logs the variant's price both **from** and **to**, so "who changed this and what was it before" is always answerable without asking anyone to remember.

This is where a store owner finds out who did what — a repriced variant shows up as `admin.variant.update`, an activation-code issue as `admin.register.code_issue`, a new product as `admin.product.create`, and so on for every entity in the system — not a separate history screen per entity.

14. The desktop shell and printing

Written in the next revision pass.